

EXCEL INTERVIEW QUESTION BANK

For Trainer Use - 40 Questions (20 Theoretical + 20 Practical)

SECTION A: THEORETICAL QUESTIONS (20)

1. What is Microsoft Excel, and what is it commonly used for?
2. What is the difference between a workbook and a worksheet?
3. What is the difference between relative, absolute, and mixed cell references?
4. What is the difference between COUNT, COUNTA, COUNTBLANK, and COUNTIF?
5. What is the difference between SUMIF and SUMIFS?
6. What is the difference between VLOOKUP and XLOOKUP?
7. What is the difference between IF, IFS, and IFERROR?
8. What is the purpose of the TRIM function?
9. What is the difference between REPLACE and SUBSTITUTE?
10. What is the difference between SEARCH and FIND?
11. What is Flash Fill, and when would you use it?
12. What is the purpose of Text to Columns?
13. What is the difference between filtering and sorting?
14. How does Remove Duplicates work in Excel?
15. What is Data Validation, and why is it useful?
16. What is Consolidate in Excel?
17. What is What-If Analysis? Name its different tools.
18. What is a PivotTable, and why is it useful for data analysis?
19. What is the difference between merging cells and combining data?
20. What is the difference between Power Query and traditional Excel formulas for data cleaning?

SECTION B: PRACTICAL QUESTIONS (20)

1. Data Cleaning

You have a column containing: " John Smith "

How would you remove the unnecessary spaces?

2. Extract First Name

Given:

Full Name

John Michael

Priya Sharma

David Kumar

Extract only the first name.

3. Extract Last Name

Using the same dataset, extract only the last name.

4. Find Duplicate Records

You have 5,000 employee records. Some Employee IDs are duplicated.

How would you identify and remove duplicate Employee IDs?

5. Conditional Calculation

You have:

Employee | Department | Salary

Arun | IT | 50000

Priya | HR | 45000

Ravi | IT | 60000

Calculate the total salary of IT employees.

6. Multiple Conditions

Using the same dataset, calculate the total salary for employees who belong to IT AND have salary greater than ₹50,000.

7. Lookup

You have an Employee ID in one table and Employee Name + Department in another.

Write a formula to retrieve the employee's department based on Employee ID.

8. Missing Lookup Values

Your lookup formula returns #N/A when an employee doesn't exist.

How would you display "Employee Not Found" instead?

9. Data Validation

Create a dropdown containing: IT, HR, Finance, Marketing, Sales

How would you create it using Data Validation?

10. Data Validation Restriction

You need to allow users to enter only values between 1 and 100 in a column.

How would you configure Data Validation?

11. Flash Fill

You have:

Full Name

John Michael

Priya Sharma

David Kumar

You manually enter John beside the first record. How can Excel automatically extract the first names for the remaining records?

12. Text to Columns

You have: "John,IT,50000" in a single cell.

How would you split it into three columns?

13. Sorting

You have 10,000 employee records. How would you sort them by Salary from highest to lowest without disturbing the relationship between employee names and salaries?

14. Filtering

From a sales dataset, display only: Region = South and Sales > ₹1,00,000

How would you apply this?

15. IF Formula

You have a Marks column. Create a formula that returns: Pass if marks ≥ 40 , Fail if marks < 40 .

16. Multiple Conditions

Create a formula that returns:

Excellent $\rightarrow$ Marks ≥ 80

Good $\rightarrow$ Marks ≥ 60

Average $\rightarrow$ Marks ≥ 40

Fail $\rightarrow$ Marks < 40

17. SUBTOTAL

You have a filtered sales dataset. After filtering for one region, calculate the total visible sales only. Which function would you use and why?

18. Consolidate

You have separate monthly sales tables for January, February, March. How would you combine the monthly totals into one summary using Consolidate?

19. What-If Analysis

A company wants to achieve ₹10 lakh profit. You know the current profit but don't know what sales value is required to reach ₹10 lakh. Which Excel What-If Analysis tool would you use, and how?

20. Data Analysis Scenario

You receive a dataset containing 50,000 customer records with duplicate IDs, extra spaces, missing values, inconsistent names, incorrect data formats, and multiple values stored in one column.

Explain the step-by-step approach you would use to clean and prepare the data for analysis.